

General Knowledge

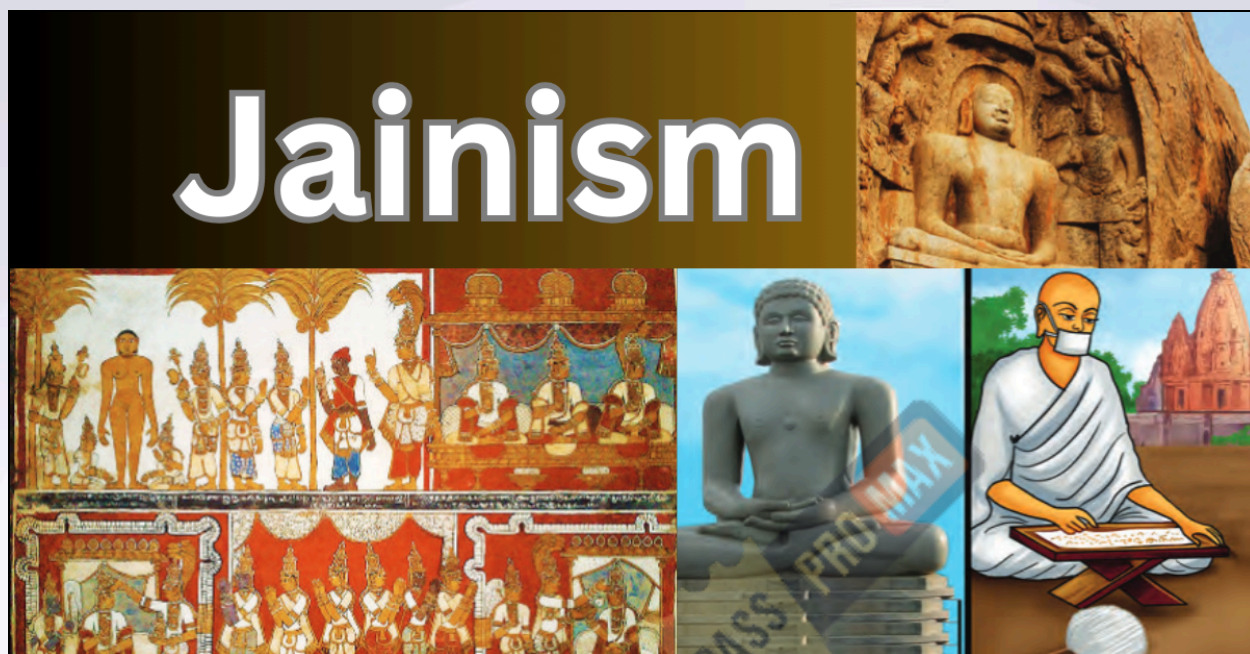
Ancient History

STUDY NOTES

Jainism



JAINISM



Emergence and Context of Jainism

- **Origin of Jainism:** Jainism emerged in the 6th century BCE in response to the increasing complexity, ritualism, and hierarchical structure of the **Vedic religion**. The religion focused on rejecting the **formalized rituals** and **Brahmin supremacy** of the time.
 - **Vedic Period Challenges:** The Vedic religion emphasized **sacrifices**, **mantras**, and **rituals** that were inaccessible to common people due to their **complexity** and **expense**. Brahmins were seen as the dominant caste with privileges, causing social unrest.
 - **Kshatriya and Vaishya Opposition:** The **Kshatriya** and **Vaishya** classes reacted against Brahmin domination, and the search for an egalitarian religious path led to the rise of Jainism and Buddhism.
- **Influence of Tirthankaras:** Jainism traces its roots through **24 Tirthankaras**, spiritual leaders who have attained enlightenment and serve as role models.
 - The first Tirthankara, **Rishabhanatha (Adinath)**, is said to have established the **Ikshvaku dynasty**.

- The most famous Tirthankara is **Vardhamana Mahavira**, the 24th Tirthankara, who propagated Jainism and gave it a structured form.

Factors Leading to the Rise of Jainism

Factors	Description
Religious Unrest	The Vedic religion was filled with complex rituals and sacrifices that were difficult for common people to follow.
Brahmin Dominance	Brahmins positioned themselves as the highest caste and demanded privileges, leading to divisions in society.
Opposition from Kshatriyas	Kshatriyas and Vaishyas opposed the rigid and dominant nature of Brahmins in religious matters.
Equality in Jainism	Jainism offered equality and provided relief from the Varna system , which divided people based on caste.
Simple Teachings	Mahavira's teachings were in Prakrit , a language spoken by common people, making them easy to understand and spread.
Doctrinal Simplicity	Jainism's doctrines focused on non-violence (Ahimsa) and self-discipline , which attracted followers who sought relief from the rigid Vedic customs .

Historical Background of Jainism

1. **Adinath/Rishabhanatha**: The first Tirthankara, **Rishabhanatha**, established the foundation for Jain teachings.
2. **Parsvanatha**: The 23rd Tirthankara, **Parsvanatha**, preached a simple form of Jainism before Mahavira. He is known for advocating **four doctrines**, which Mahavira later expanded to five. Parsvanatha's followers practised non-violence, truth, non-stealing, and renunciation.
3. **Vardhamana Mahavira**: The 24th Tirthankara, born in **540 BCE** in **Kundagrama**, near Vaishali, in modern-day Bihar.

- **Parents:** Father **Siddhartha** was the head of the **Jnatrika** clan, and his mother **Trishala** was a Lichchavi princess.
- **Marriage and Family:** He was married to **Yashoda** and had a daughter named **Anojja**.
- **Renunciation:** At the age of **30**, he renounced worldly life and became an ascetic. For **12 years**, he practised **severe austerities** before attaining **Kevala Jnana** (Supreme Knowledge) at the age of **42**.
- **Preaching:** Mahavira spent **30 years** spreading Jainism across northern India, particularly in **Kosala, Magadha, and Mithila**.
- **Death:** He passed away at the age of **72** in **468 BCE** at **Pavapuri, Bihar**.

Tirthankars



Tirthankara	Place of Birth	Symbol	Important Point
1. Rishabhanatha	Ayodhya	Bull	First Tirthankara, founder of Ikshvaku dynasty
2. Ajitanatha	Ayodhya	Elephant	Invincible one, second Tirthankara
3. Sambhavanatha	Sravasti	Horse	Symbolizes auspiciousness, third Tirthankara
4. Abhinandananaatha	Ayodhya	Ape	Represents worship, fourth Tirthankara
5. Sumatinatha	Ayodhya	Heron	Represents wisdom, fifth Tirthankara
6. Padmaprabha	Kausambi	Lotus	Known as "Lotus Bright," sixth Tirthankara
7. Suparshvanatha	Varanasi	Swastika	"Good Sided," seventh Tirthankara
8. Chandraprabha	Chandrapuri	Moon	"Moon Bright," eighth Tirthankara
9. Suvidhinatha (Pushpadanta)	Kakandi	Dolphin or Sea Dragon	"Blossom-toothed," ninth Tirthankara
10. Shitalanatha	Bhadrikapuri	Shrivatsa	Coolness, tenth Tirthankara
11. Shreyansanatha	Simhapuri	Rhinoceros	Represents goodness, eleventh Tirthankara
12. Vasupujya	Champapuri	Buffalo	Worshipped through offerings, twelfth Tirthankara
13. Vimalanatha	Kampilya	Boar	Clear and pure, thirteenth Tirthankara

14. Anantanatha	Ayodhya	Hawk or Bear	Endless or infinite, fourteenth Tirthankara
15. Dharmanatha	Ratnapuri	Thunderbolt	Duty-bound, fifteenth Tirthankara
16. Shantinatha	Hastinapur	Deer	Represents peace, sixteenth Tirthankara
17. Kunthunatha	Hastinapur	Goat	Represents a heap of jewels, seventeenth Tirthankara
18. Aranatha	Hastinapur	Fish or Nandyavarta	Represents time division, eighteenth Tirthankara
19. Mallinatha	Mithila	Water Pot	The only female Tirthankara (19th), nineteenth Tirthankara
20. Munisuvrata	Rajagriha	Tortoise	Symbol of good vows, twentieth Tirthankara
21. Naminatha	Mithila	Blue Lotus	Represents bowing down or winking of the eye, twenty-first Tirthankara
22. Neminatha (Arishtanemi)	Sauripur	Conch Shell	Rim of whose wheel is unhurt, twenty-second Tirthankara
23. Parshvanatha	Varanasi	Snake	Twenty-third Tirthankara, believed in the eternity of matter
24. Mahavira	Kundagrama (Vaishali)	Lion	Last and 24th Tirthankara, founder of Jainism in its current form

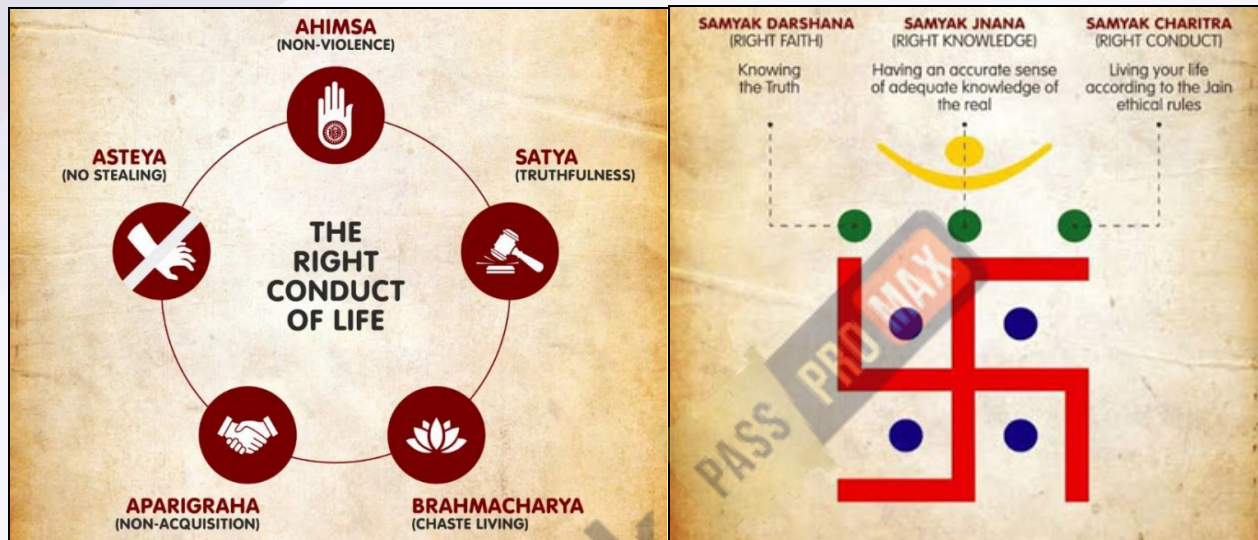
Jain Councils

Council	Year	Venue	Presided By	Outcome
First Jain Council	300 BCE	Pataliputra (Bihar)	Sthulbhadra	Compilation of Jain canon into 12 Angas.
Second Jain Council	512 CE	Vallabhi (Gujarat)	Devardhigani Kshemasarmana	Expansion of Jain canon with Upangas and final compilation of scriptures.

Teachings of Mahavira



- **Ultimate Goal:** The central goal of Jainism is to achieve **Moksha** (liberation) from the cycle of birth, pain, and death, known as **Nirvana**. This state is achieved through the removal of karma and the purification of the soul.
- **Five Doctrines (Pancha Mahavratas):** Mahavira expanded upon the teachings of earlier Tirthankaras, particularly **Parsvanatha**, to form five key principles for ascetics and householders:



Doctrine	Description
Ahimsa	Non-violence toward all living beings, emphasizing complete avoidance of harm.
Satya	Always speak the truth, as lies are seen as harmful and unethical.
Asteeya	Do not steal or take anything that is not freely given.
Aparigraha	Renounce material possessions and practice non-attachment.
Brahmacharya	Practice celibacy and chastity, which Mahavira added to Parsvanatha's four doctrines.

- **Three Jewels (Ratnatraya):** The path to liberation involves following these three essential principles:

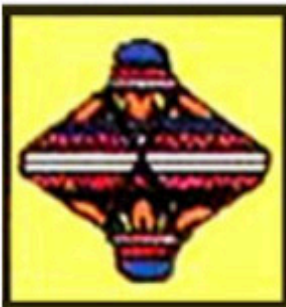
Principle	Description
Samyak Darshan	Right faith involves the rejection of superstitions and the acceptance of truth.
Samyak Gyan	Right knowledge, understanding the nature of reality without false perceptions.
Samyak Charitra	Right conduct, practising ethical behaviour in every aspect of life.

- **Concept of Soul and Matter:** Mahavira taught that the universe consists of two fundamental entities:
 - **Jiva (soul):** The conscious, living entity that accumulates karma through desires and actions.
 - **Ajiva (matter):** The non-living elements of the universe. According to Jainism, all beings have a soul, even inanimate objects, which can experience suffering.
- **Anuvratas:** For householders, Mahavira prescribed a simplified version of the five great vows, known as **Anuvratas**, to help them live virtuous lives without the strict renunciation required of monks.

Jain Symbols and Knowledge

Symbol	Description
Swastika	Represents the peace and well-being of all humans.
Nandavarta	A large swastika with nine endpoints symbolises spiritual advancement.
Bhadrasana	A throne , sanctified by the feet of Tirthankaras, symbolizing the sanctity of the enlightened ones.
Shrivatsa	A mark on the chest of Tirthankaras represents the pure soul of enlightened beings.
Darpana	A mirror symbolises self-reflection and the discovery of the inner self.

Minayugala	A pair of fish , symbolises the conquest over sexual desires .
Vardhamanaka	A shallow dish , used as a lamp, represents the increase in wealth, merit, and prosperity .
Kalasha	A pot filled with pure water represents purity and the well-being of all beings.

Swastika 	Nandavarta 	Bhadrasana 	Shrivatsa 
Darpana 	Minayugala 	Vardhamanaka 	Kalasha 

Types of Knowledge in Jainism

Jainism teaches five types of knowledge, each with a different level of perception:

Type of Knowledge	Description
Mati Jnana	Knowledge through the senses and mind.
Sruta Jnana	Knowledge is obtained from scriptures and teachings.
Avadhi Jnana	Clairvoyant knowledge of distant objects or events.
Manahparyaya Jnana	Telepathic knowledge is the ability to know others' thoughts.
Kevala Jnana	The highest form of knowledge, omniscience is attainable through enlightenment.

Jain Literature

Jain literature is divided into two main categories:

Agam Literature (Canonical Texts)

- **Lord Mahavir's Teachings:** Jain Agam literature contains the direct teachings of Lord Mahavir, compiled by his followers.
- **Ang-agamas (Main Texts):**
 - These texts were compiled by **Ganadharas**, Lord Mahavir's immediate disciples.
 - All Ganadharas possessed **Keval-Gyan** (perfect knowledge) and compiled twelve main texts known as **Ang-agamas**.
- **Ang-bahya-agamas (Secondary Texts):**
 - These are expansions of the Ang-agamas. They were written by monks called **Shrutakevalins**, who had knowledge of at least ten Purvas.
 - These texts provide further explanation of the Ang-agamas and are collectively called **Ang-bahya-agams**.
 - The **twelfth Ang-agama** is called **Drastivad**, which consists of fourteen **Purva texts** (Purva-agams), considered the oldest sacred Jain texts.
- **Language:** All Agam literature is written in **Prakrit**, a language that was commonly spoken at the time.

Non-Agam Literature (Secondary Texts)

- This category includes **commentaries** and **explanations** of Agam literature.
- It also consists of **independent works** written by elder monks, nuns, and scholars.
- Non-Agam literature is written in various languages including **Prakrit, Sanskrit, Old Marathi, Gujarati, Hindi, Kannada, Tamil, German, and English.**

Jain Architecture

Jain architecture, though influenced by Hindu and Buddhist styles, developed its own unique features.

Caves (Layana/Gumphas):

- Jain monks and devotees lived in rock-cut caves.
- **Examples of Jain Caves:**
 - **Ellora Caves (Cave No. 30-35),** Maharashtra
 - **Mangi Tungi Cave,** Maharashtra
 - **Gajapantha Cave,** Maharashtra
 - **Udayagiri-Khandagiri Caves,** Odisha
 - **Hathi-gumpha Cave,** Odisha
 - **Sittanavasal Cave,** Tamil Nadu

Statues:

- Jainism is known for creating grand statues of its Tirthankaras and deities.
- **Famous Jain Statues:**
 - **Gomateshwara/Bahubali Statue,** Shravanabelagola, Karnataka (One of the tallest monolithic statues in the world)
 - **Statue of Ahimsa (Rishabhnaatha),** Mangi-Tungi hills, Maharashtra

Jinalaya (Temples):

- Jain temples, also known as **Jinalayas**, are famous for their intricate architecture and marble work.
- **Famous Jain Temples:**

- **Dilwara Temple**, Mount Abu, Rajasthan (Renowned for its intricate marble carvings)
- **Girnar and Palitana Temples**, Gujarat
- **Muktagiri Temple**, Maharashtra

Important Architectural Features:

- **Manastambha**: A religious ornamental pillar with a Tirthankar image on all four cardinal directions. Found in front of Jain temples, this structure holds great spiritual significance.
- **Basadis**: These are Jain monastic establishments or temples, especially prominent in Karnataka.

Doctrine of Syadvada and Anekantavada

1. **Syadvada**: Jainism teaches that all judgments are **conditional** and can only be fully understood under certain conditions. The word "**Syat**" means "**maybe**" and indicates that reality is multifaceted. Syadvada promotes intellectual flexibility and an understanding that different perspectives reveal different aspects of truth.
2. **Anekantavada**: The doctrine of **Anekantavada** suggests that **reality is complex** and can only be fully understood by considering multiple perspectives. It teaches that absolute truth is beyond human comprehension, and we must remain open to other viewpoints.

Sects of Jainism: Digambara and Svetambara

Aspect	Digambara	Svetambara
Meaning	Sky-clad (nudity as a symbol of renunciation).	White-clad (wear white clothing).
Position on Women	Women cannot achieve liberation without rebirth as a man.	Women can attain liberation.
Idols	Nude idols of Tirthankaras, are shown with eyes downcast.	Adorned idols with eyes open, often with jewels.

Founder	Bhadrabahu led the migration during the 12-year famine.	Sthulbhadra led the sect that stayed in Magadha.
Monastic Practices	Strict asceticism, including nudity for monks.	Monks wear white clothes and follow a more relaxed ascetic code.

Sub-sects of Jainism under Digambaras and Svetambaras:

Sub-sects (Digambaras)	Description	Sub-sects (Svetambaras)	Description
Mula Sangh	Associated with Acharya Kundakunda . Known from 430 AD. Branches include Nandi Gana, Sena Gana, Deva Gana, and Simha Gana.	Sthanakavasi	They believe in praying to Saints instead of idols. The saints wear a muhapatti near their mouth to cover it.
Bisapantha	They worship Tirthankaras, Yakshas, and Yakshinis . Their religious practices include aarti , offerings of flowers, fruits, and prasad . Bhattarakas are considered dharma gurus. Primarily found in Rajasthan, Gujarat .	Murtipujaka (Deravasi)	They keep idols of Tirthankaras at their temples and worship them. Saints do not wear a muhapatti .
Digambar Terapantha	Worship idols with 'ashtadravya' , but replace flowers and fruits with dry substitutes. They do not accept Bhattarakas and only worship Tirthankaras .	Terapanthi	Similar to Sthanakavasi, they pray to saints rather than idols. Terapanthi saints also wear a muhapatti near their mouth to cover it.

Taranpantha	They strongly refute idolatry , but have temples where they keep their sacred books for worship . Emphasize spiritual values and the study of sacred literature.		
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Spread of Jainism to Other Parts of India

- **Contribution of Mahavira:**
 - Mahavira traveled extensively, preaching his teachings across various regions.
 - His simple life, penance, and austerity attracted many people, who were inspired by his way of living.
 - Mahavira had **eleven disciples** known as **Ganadharas** or heads of schools.
 - After Mahavira's death, **Arya Sudharma** was the only surviving Ganadhara and became the first **Thera** (chief preceptor) of the Jain order.
- **Role of Jain Monks:**
 - Jain monks played a key role in spreading Jainism by visiting different regions and engaging in **scholarly discussions**.
 - Their **personal simplicity and ascetic lifestyles** influenced people significantly, spreading the teachings of Jainism further.
- **Royal Patronage:**
 - Jainism spread widely due to the **patronage of various kings**.
 - **Udayin**, the successor of Ajatasatru, was a devoted Jaina.
 - **Chandragupta Maurya**, a follower of Jainism, migrated with **Bhadrabahu** to South India, further spreading Jainism in southern regions.
 - **Mathura and Ujjain** emerged as major centers of Jainism during the early centuries of the Christian era.
 - Two Theras, **Sambhutavijaya and Bhadrabahu**, played important roles in the Jain order during the time of the Nanda dynasty.

Relevance of Jain Ideology in Today's World

- **Anektavada (Non-Absolutism):**
 - Promotes the spirit of **intellectual and social tolerance** in today's world, advocating for an understanding of multiple perspectives.
- **Non-Violence (Ahimsa):**
 - The principle of **non-violence** holds great significance in today's context, especially in a world facing the threat of **nuclear weapons** and widespread violence.
 - It emphasizes achieving long-lasting **peace** in society through non-violence.
- **Aparigraha (Non-Attachment):**
 - The concept of **Aparigraha** can help curb the growing consumerism, greed, and possessiveness prevalent in modern society.
 - It promotes living a life of **minimalism** and detachment from material desires, which is crucial for reducing conflict and fostering harmony.
- **Triratna (Three Jewels):**
 - The **doctrine of Triratna** (Right Faith, Right Knowledge, Right Conduct) remains relevant today as it emphasizes **moral integrity, equality, and self-discipline**.
 - The principles of Jainism help in empowering both **women and men** towards achieving **liberty and freedom** from societal subjugation and constraints.